A loss is either gonna take you out teach you something. It's a step closer to your moonshot

Channel: Greg Lav · Published: Nov 08, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/vzr63piSWzM Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Greg Lav recounts blowing their entire $10,000 savings on Instagram meme ads that delivered zero relevant results, then reframes all business losses as either fatal endings or valuable lessons.

📑 Contents

- 💸 The $10,000 Meme Ad Disaster
- 🎓 Reframing Loss as a Lesson

💸 The $10,000 Meme Ad Disaster 0:00

- Greg and his partner Mari had worked hard to accumulate exactly **$10,000** in their bank account — their entire savings at the time
- They decided to invest the full $10,000 into promotions on three large Instagram meme pages
  - The social media landscape they were operating in was described as "completely different" from today
  - Greg was extremely excited, telling Mari: *"Today is going to change our lives. We've never invested this much in a 24-hour window. We're going to get a lot of followers and a ton of traffic to our Shopify store."*
- They launched the meme ads and waited for results
  - The only followers that came in were from **India** — to Mari's and Bloom's accounts
  - Their business only sold products in the **United States**
  - Indian followers provided zero commercial value to their US-only Shopify store
- The outcome: the entire $10,000 was completely wasted
  - Greg described it as money that "went into the water and burned to ash"
  - Mari called it plainly: *"It was a disaster."*

🎓 Reframing Loss as a Lesson 0:22

- Greg uses this story to deliver a broader mindset principle about handling losses in business and life
- His core argument: **a loss is only truly a loss if it completely destroys you**
  - If the loss wipes you out entirely and you stop — that is a loss
  - If you survive it and keep going — it becomes a lesson, not a loss

> "A loss only takes you out if it finishes you. If it doesn't finish you, those are lessons."

- The implication is that every painful setback is a step closer to your eventual breakthrough (the "moonshot") as long as you stay in the game